CONTACT

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

- Versatile social work professional with a Master of Social Sciences in Social Work and a Bachelor of Social Work from the University of Fort Hare. Brings experience across child protection and safeguarding, psychosocial support, community-based programming, monitoring and evaluation, facilitation, administration and operational coordination. Experienced in supporting referral pathways, maintaining confidential records, collecting and documenting programme information, facilitating workshops, and engaging with children, caregivers, families, community stakeholders and learners from diverse cultural backgrounds. Combines practice-based experience with qualitative research training, ethical participant engagement and an interest in applied research that can strengthen psychosocial wellbeing and service delivery.

EDUCATION

2014
- **University of Fort Hare**
  Bachelor of Social Work

2017
- **University of Fort Hare**
  Master of Social Sciences in Social Work

WORK EXPERIENCE

November 2023 - May 2025
- **Child Protection & Psychosocial Support Facilitator**
  DZIKWA TRUST FUND
  • Supported child protection, safeguarding and psychosocial programmes for children, adolescents and caregivers.
  • Maintained confidential records and supported case identification, referrals, follow-up, monitoring and reporting.
  • Facilitated workshops and community programmes for children, caregivers and community stakeholders.
  • Worked with families, schools, community leaders, volunteers and service providers to support community-level protection and wellbeing.
  • Contributed to programme monitoring, data collection and reporting, applying ethical and safeguarding principles.

January 2025 - Ongoing
- **Founder and Volunteer Facilitator**
  Simuka Tiende Mwanasikana
  • Founded a free online psychosocial support initiative for women experiencing emotional and social challenges.
  • Used Facebook and WhatsApp to provide an accessible space for supportive discussion and connection; the initiative's website was developed in 2026.
  • Facilitates conversations about emotional wellbeing, isolation, grief, loss, relationships, life transitions and changing support needs.

• Uses active listening and strengths-based communication, and signposts participants to relevant support where appropriate.

October 2017 - April 2018

- **Monitoring & Evaluation Assistant**
  ZIMTTECH
  • Supported data collection, verification and documentation for community healthcare programmes.
  • Assisted with monitoring activities, tracking indicators and preparing programme reports.
  • Worked with programme staff and partners to support accurate and timely reporting.
  • Applied confidentiality and ethical standards when handling programme information.
  Kids Haven Children's Home — South Africa

October 2022 - August 2023

- **English Language Freelance Teacher- Online**
  International Language Institute, Poland
  • Taught English to learners from diverse cultural and linguistic backgrounds.
  • Adapted teaching methods, communication styles and learning activities to meet different learning needs.
  • Planned and delivered structured lessons focused on language development and practical communication.
  • Maintained learner-related information and supported lesson planning and organisation.

May 2019 - January 2022

- **Sales and Operations Manager**
  Mavericks Sports Betting
  • Coordinated operational and administrative activities within a fast-paced organisation.
  • Supported staff coordination, day-to-day team requirements and service delivery.
  • Managed records and documentation and communicated with customers and stakeholders to address operational needs.
  • Supported reporting and the use of digital systems, prioritising organisation, problem-solving and timely follow-up.

January 2013 - June 2013

- **Student Social Worker**
  Kids Haven Children's Home, South Africa
  • Supported residential programmes for vulnerable children and adolescents.
  • Participated in case management meetings and psychosocial support activities.
  • Contributed to child-centred practice and maintained appropriate professional boundaries and confidentiality.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Master's Researcher — University of Fort Hare | 2015–2017
  • Completed an independent qualitative study examining challenges experienced by a police child protection unit in providing services to vulnerable children.

• Developed and implemented a qualitative research design using purposive sampling and in-depth/semi-structured interviews.
• Engaged with sensitive information using ethical research practices, including informed consent, confidentiality and participant protection.
• Applied open coding and thematic analysis to identify patterns in qualitative data.
• Produced a Master's dissertation examining social, institutional and systemic factors affecting child protection service delivery.

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

- • Research: qualitative research design, in-depth and semi-structured interviewing, purposive sampling, thematic analysis, qualitative coding, literature review, academic writing, research ethics and data management.
  • Social work practice: psychosocial support, social work assessment and intervention, risk identification and referral, family and caregiver support, community mobilisation, trauma-informed and strengths-based practice.
  • Programme and leadership: programme implementation, monitoring and evaluation, reporting, workshop facilitation, training and mentoring, stakeholder engagement, documentation and community initiative development.
  • Administration and communication: confidential record management, activity coordination, Microsoft Office and digital systems, interpersonal communication and cross-cultural collaboration.

PROJECTS

- **Founded a Women's Psychosocial initiative**
  https://www.simukatiende.co.zw/

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

• Valid Class 4 Driver's Licence.
• Available for relocation and field travel.

REFERENCE

- **Available on Request - ""**